Posthumanism and the novel SoSe19

Professor: James Dorson

Eun Soo Hong

Student ID: 5372201

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Progress of Post-humanist values: Examining 10 years of generational difference shown between the Blade Runner and Do Androids Dream of Electric Sheep?

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1.Introduction to the goal of this research

When the novel gains enough sensation to be transformed into a movie production, it usually comes from a place of shared values and understandings in that society. Only the fictional tale that correlates to current events or corresponds to ideological paradigm of the era has a chance to win the overwhelming supports of its audience. Social injustice and problematic issues embedded in those values are cast doubt on by taking an extreme measure to depict the worst-case scenarios in analogical terms. When the story gets selected to enter the movie industry, it would be a hope of the original author of novels to disseminate these underlying messages and in turn raise public awareness.

Unfortunately, most theatrical production does not entirely follow the suit of its precedents. Since film compared to paper book is more strongly entertainment-driven, it inevitably goes through a certain level of modification to fit its commercial purpose. Movie adaptation in general, dilutes profound social implication of its original piece and instead replaces diluteness with light-hearted provocative themes. Moreover, if there are considerable amounts of generational gap between book publishing and movie production dates, shift in understanding of the same subject may be reflected. In this case, the way director accounts for one incident may differ from the way the writer has previously done. Subtle change of context in the movie, therefore, becomes a great indicator of progress of ideas imbued in the original novel. Thus, while it may be important to stay alert in elements of commercial modification, checking how the movie depiction departs from the initial plotline will provide profound insights on ideological shift of predominant values or ideas at the time.

Blade Runner, a movie produced in 1982 borrows its plotline from 1968 Phillip K Dick's novel Do Androids Dream of Electric Sheep? Central theme of both renditions engages with the idea of post humanism, casting doubts on the narrow definition of 'human' imposed by philosophical and ethical stance of humanism. Development of post humanist ideas intersects with changes of social perception that challenges this narrow definition. [1]In humanist standard, only those who meets the strict criteria on sex, race and state of being were entitled to privileges of being acknowledged as 'human'. These three criteria were each challenged over the period

[1] Ehrenfeld, David W. The Arrogance of Humanism. Oxford University Press, 1981.

of 20th century on a series of occasion such as feminist movement, anti-fascism and growing consensus on racial equality, and development of science technology. The span of past 100 year can be summarized as ongoing social dynamics susceptible to changes at every minute. This is the reason why it is important to analyze the effect period of each state had on ideological paradigm that took strong hold of public's mind at every stage.

Given the importance even minute of change could have during this period, 10 years would have resulted in shifts of thoughts and ideas to a considerable extent. The year difference between completion date of two renditions amounts to over 10 years which makes them worth of comparison. By examining the key differences between the book and the movie we will attempt to gain a general overview of the changes occurred during the era. Then, by applying background knowledge on post humanism and social dynamics that took place over the span of 14years, this paper will aim for coming to a closer picture of understanding what literary implication such variations have. In the end, it would be the ultimate goal to understand progress of post humanist values in the period of most rapid and dynamic changes.

1.1 Humanism, Anti-humanism and Post-humanism

Prior to beginning an analysis, it would be important to understand the concepts of post-humanism along with other ideological beliefs that contributed to its development. Accounting for how post humanism came about, it was a reactionary response against ideas of humanism which valued human agency, specifically a capacity of human to think rationally and critically (Ehrendeld 30). To one's dismay, despite its claim for objective and rational attitude, most of its founding principles were based on subjective and distorted view of the world. Taking science where heart of rationality was lied to be believed for instance, the use and abuse of scientific experiment under Fascism and in the colonial era prove that science is not immunized against nationalist, racist and hegemonic discourse and practices (Braidotti 32). In other words, scientific results were not interpreted neutrally to aim for objectivity but was rather manipulated to validate dominant belief whether that is objective truth or not.

One defining characteristic of humanism was that it was Eurocentric, meaning that under this paradigm, Europe announces itself as the site of origin of critical reason and self-reflexivity (Bradiotti 15). This assumption of Europe having the universalizing power of self-reflective

reason granted western civilization boundless capacity to pursue perfectibility as opposed to limited ability of other entities confined to its specificity. Hence, it led up to definition which was exclusive to other race and ethnicity to the extent that it reduced non-western others to a sub-human status. Because humanism operated on a binary logic between the norm and otherness any slight variation spelled inferior lethal connotation of being 'other'. Thus, those that are branded as 'other' in racial terms is called 'racialized others'. Another major categorical divide of otherness was sex. While secularism and aversion to church and religion was key definition of humanism, women have historically been assigned roles in private and religious domain. [2]Associating women with religious faith and belief instead of granting them rights to be active in public domain fell short of definition on human agency. Male, on the other hand, were given roles of rational and critical thinking, practicing the full political citizenship in public affairs. As this triggered the sexual inequality among two genders women are branded as 'sexualized others'. The last discrimination point was state of being or human and non-human 'naturalized others'. Upon the intervention of technological artefacts, human's agency in making decision has been fearfully questioned. Technological tool often surpassed its auxiliary role to provide guidance and in turn, both human and non-human other living species formed a mutual dependence. This threatened humanist notion on boundless capacity of human to make rational decision without any external assistance.

After the Second World War, Humanist ideal came to be questioned radically. This marked a decline of humanism and its Eurocentric core and imperial tendencies. Rejection of humanism in the 1960s and 1970s came in the form of social movement and advent of new youth cultures. Feminism, de-colonization, anti-racism, anti-nuclear and pacifist movement all contributed to formation of this new wave of thought. The changing understanding of human subjectivity that grew to accept more diverse categories of individuals was made viable by stepping out of the previous dialectical oppositional thinking. It also attacked logic of human's agency that was believed to led up to an enlightenment. This is where notion of decentralization comes in. By phrasing human as 'de-centered' subject it denies almighty ability of human agency and stresses structure and social relations to have primacy over individual consciousness. The decentralization is then later interpreted as disassembling of centralized power structure to assert the need for loving respect for diversity in both its human and non-human forms.

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[2] Baxi, Upendra. Human Rights in a Posthuman World: Critical Essays. Oxford University Press, 2010.

Written in a slightly different context, post-humanism had undeniably been influenced by anti-humanist thoughts. However, it diverges from the past stage of theoretical framework in that it attempts to move beyond lethal binaries and impose new alternatives. The above emancipatory movement by structuralized 'others' did not only protest against the former humanist 'center' or dominant subject position, but also seek to reinvent other versions of self-reflexivity. The differences that once put others in a marginalized position are now used as an opportunity to re-establish new meanings of subjectivity. Post structuralist idea formed a foundation post humanist position was built upon. Structuralism was a view of privileging power of language and culture that precedes individual subject (Govey 20). Post structuralism moves beyond fixed meaning of these elements and assumes fluidity over all matters including culture, a byproduct of human interaction that occurs through situational factor in the given environment. In the end, the journey stretches from assumption of central figure in enlightenment humanism to rejection of that central power and eventually moving up to an alternative approach on reconstructing power structure all together in a non-fixated world view.

1.2 Philosophical generation of 1960s & 1970s

As mentioned earlier, the era of 20th century was filled with ongoing social dynamics of different 'structuralized other' entities raising awareness on death of narrow-minded humanist thoughts. Particularly, the decades of 1960s and 1970s experienced extreme dynamism with an engagement of social and cultural politics of the generation known as baby-boomers. These two decades were also filled with historical phenomena remembered as failing of political experiments such as Fascism and Holocaust. Living up to witness the absurdness of traumatic legacy resting on humanistic norms, rejection of humanism might have been a corollary. The followings are three different incidents that became the philosophical turning point in understanding humanity.

To begin with, fascist ruling of Germany and subsequent disastrous effects it caused in the world war two was underlying factor in transforming perception of race in humanism. The period of Nazism exercised Eurocentric principle of what counts as human. Jews were outside the boundary of western citizen and thus, was labeled as the inferior racialized others. This did not only lead to simple feeling of alienation or deprivation of political rights, but it also put them under life-threatening situation of genocide. When the war ended with the surrender of

German forces, it added proof on the wrongdoings of crimes committed in the name of humanity. In fact, Fascism operated on a distorted view of humanism in its ruthless departure from the very roots of Enlightenment-based respect for the autonomy of reason and the moral good (Braidotti 17). Because humanism often missed its moral core of believing that all persons are inherently free and equal, it lost faith of the public. The subsequent alternative of communism which unlike fascism does not condemn differences as source of discrimination did not live long as well. Disharmony of Europe perpetuated by the following cold years led to ultimate replacement of communist ideals to post humanist notion that overturned ideal of western man as the standard of perfectibility. Afterall, even Marxism relied on grandeur of European thought as propeller of human history.

On top of this racial discourse, feminist critique like Sartre and de Beauvoir emphasized social construction of women alongside the criticism on social construct of man. Rejection of idealized human agency and his universalistic posture was supported by the claim that [3]individualism is not part of intrinsic human nature. Post-structuralist relativist view on what constitutes culture and human being was applied to criticizing idea of man as a canon of perfect proportions. Because all things existing in universe are the result of interaction and influence of neighboring elements, the so-called ideal of Man that possesses limitless power of enlightenment is an illusion. Individualism that drives the progress of civilization is a historical construct contingent on values and locations surrounding that individual. The only reason man has thought upon to have the status of a natural law was because it was manipulated to be viewed in that particular way by the society. Similarly, women designated as 'sexualized others' are not inherently inferior but only have been inferiorly defined by the society. The way two genders diverge from each other is not an intrinsic characteristic predetermined at birth (Davis 52). It is a result of education on socialization that shapes sexual identity by learning what would be socially acceptable in one's position or not. In the end, because sexual exclusivity of humanism is based on illusioned hierarchical belief, it becomes imperative that we deconstruct prerogatives in male dominant culture.

The last major turning point in contemporary post-human debate comes from studies of science and technology. The last century has seen major progress in science and technology.

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[3] Davis, Flora. Moving the Mountain: the Womens Movement in America since 1960. University of Illinois Press, 1999.

Various technological artefacts that facilitate daily lives of human came to existence during mid 1900s including telephone, automobile and more recently robots. As these artefacts began to engage in human activity once thought as exclusive property of men, it raised conceptual and ethical question on the status of human beings. On the one hand, science and biotechnology consolidates relationship between human and non-human living others (Vint 10). It mediates distanced relationship between two as can be seen in the example of social robot that fills up the voidness of those who live alone. On the other hand, the flipside of increasing level of interconnectedness is that it blurs the dividing line between two entities incurring a questionable debate on understanding human subject. Moral status of humanity is threatened as sovereignty of human is no longer intact. [4]Moreover, technological achievements of 60s and 70s entailed a possibility of post-anthropocentric turn where not only moral intentionality of human but also that of technology became issue worth of discussion. The fear of technological entities gaining autonomy and acting upon their own principles has been projected in numerous novels and science fictions during the era. In fact, this would be where topic of the above selected novel and movie centers around.

2. Analyzing the key differences between the book and the movie

The first striking difference to be found is the level of emphasis put on empathy as a barometer that sets human apart from robots. In Dick's novel robot's lack of empathy has constantly been used as justification for their pitiless murder and 'less-than human status'. Voight-kampff test, the only valid testing method to filter nexus 6 models out of rest of humanity measures reactionary minutes required to reach responses of emotionally-triggering situations. For androids that does not show immediate reaction after hearing tragic news of others, they are heartless subjects incapable of feeling emotions like love, fear and guilt. In the movie however, actors who play robots, or androids, display subtle emotional changes upon their interaction with human. Rachel, a replicant made as a trial of new model in Rosen association, and whom Deckard feels affectionate towards to, is in return emotionally drawn to Rick. This stands in contrast to Rachel Rosen in the novel who remains aloof and feigned emotion to be

[4] Vint, Sherryl. Bodies of Tomorrow: Technology, Subjectivity, Science Fiction. University Og Toronto Press, 2007.

manipulative of her actions. At the climax of the movie, the battle between Deckard and Roy, the android, too ends with alluding a room for empathizing ability of robots when he saves Deckard on the verge of his death. Overall, the replicants were violent criminals but their action only came out of emotion-based reason whether it was a mournful death of his peer or fear of their own death.

Second, the identity of 'chicken head' is erased off from the movie. J.F Sebastian, a character supposedly modeled after J.R Isadore of the book does not assume another sub-human status with lower than average intelligence. Effects this modification can have is for one, it simplifies or reduces diversity of otherness. Because chicken head was part of another group category of marginalized position, it represented different categorical divide that coexists with others similar to how in post humanism sex, race and state of being were all together set up as judging criteria. Erasing this identity reduces complexity and concentrates focus on dichotomized view of human and naturalized others. In other words, it obliterates any side-tracking elements. The fact that once, a narrator whose perspective half of the story is told through, was reduced to a supporting role may add evidence to this narrowing of topic. But on top of this simplification role, it is of question whether keeping mental disability off the subject has to do with changes in social circumstances throughout 10-year gap. For instance, one speculation could be that perhaps the war-time induced disability of veteran that once resonated with people of 1960s has lost its relevance after a decade. Chicken head being caused by an exposure to radioactive dust and fallouts bears similarity to this disability in that it is an externally triggered difference.

Another aspect to look on is the way status is labelled in the imaginary society. Aside from the change of the main title that impacts the obvious first impression of the story, there have been several name changes in referring the same subject. The first would be the title change of bounty hunter to blade runner. Each gives a different nuance in perceiving the action of killing or retiring robots. The former phrases the action as part of an everyday occupation, whereas the latter would be more explicit word choice, inferring that the action is inherently provocative. In fact, such corresponds to the fact that in book, Deckard was a full-time bounty hunter who had no difficulty in retiring androids. Retiring robot will be just another happenings of his working environment that the scene was depicted in dryasdust manners. On the contrary, Deckard in the movie was retired personnel who was called up to undertake the task of killing replicants because he was the only human resource left capable to do so. Therefore, not being a professional work force, he constantly faced challenges which lead to more explicit and brutal

depictions. Another change was reference of andies or androids to replicants. This new way of phrasing shifts perception of robots from having own established identity called ‘androids’ to a technological artefact that is essentially an extension, a replication, of human. Perhaps interconnectedness displayed by sharing of emotional feelings can be understood as stemming from this similarity human and robots share.

Meanwhile, several female characters have gone absent in the transformation process. Viewing the changes in feminist perspective, there are two things to take a closer look on. The first is aforementioned relationship between Deckard and Rachel and the second would be deletion of female human and android characters. While the relationship between two individuals was explained as unilateral in the novel, the movie reinterprets as mutual feelings. Because androids in films were imposed of ability to empathize and have emotional experience, Rachel falls in love with Deckard. In the novel however, no matter how much he feels fond of her she does not reply back in a genuine way but instead takes advantage of his feelings. In one sense, one-way love in relationship and that subject being male, the more dominant among two genders, opens up a discussion on sexual harassment. Indeed, even in the movie the way Deckard expressed his affection was somewhat violent. Plot change into a bilateral relationship alludes female empowerment as now the woman is given sovereignty to control her emotion in the male-female relationship. However, love partner of both Deckard and Roy Batty were left out. Iran, a wife of Deckard whom he lost any interest and also a great contrasting point with how he affects female androids is not mentioned. This, on top of absence of another female character makes the plot primarily male driven. Hence, the transference has possibility to be interpreted as both reflection of growing and fading interest in feminist ideal.

Finally, continuing with the examination on missing elements of the novel, importance of some ‘structuralized otherness’ were reduced. The electric animals for instance, bears less importance in film than in the book. While it is agreed upon that real live animals are valuable assets worth more money than electric ones, they’re not being utilized in development of plot as much as in the original story. In the book, the reason why Deckard is determined to take on the role of killing androids was to afford real animals, a fact never mentioned in its movie adaptation. Electronic animals fall into the category of double naturalization because not only does it counts as otherness by being non-human living organism but also by being non-organic non-human others. Moreover, the non-human otherness can be said to be made to stand out less in the movie in that identity or Rick Deckard as real human is questioned. While it has been

ascertained that Deckard is not an android in the written version of the story, in film this was a fact left unproven. In fact, director of the movie once made a remark in his interview that 'yes, he is an android'. The mood organ was another missing element in the film. This technological device that helps you feel in a certain way by punching a code, questions autonomous boundary of human. Being an explicit example of how technology interferes with human agency, taking this section of plot away reduces emphasis on debate regarding naturalized otherness.

2.1 Sexualized Others

Now that the differences have been analyzed, it is time to look in detail of how changing perception of each sub-theme of post humanism reflects progress of ideas in concurring period. Because having a post humanist turn derives from a desire to overcome exclusive definition of human in humanism, reevaluating traditionally assigned gender roles that marginalized female population was one of its kickoff points. As mentioned earlier, mid-20th century saw a rise of idea that gender identity is a social construct far from one's inherent characteristic. Both men and women each being confined to public and private domain began to be understood as no longer a given fact but a restriction of individual freedom. [5]The need to liberate one from conventional definition of each gender became crucial. This would be the first trend reflected in plot modification into a movie. In book, Deckard's fulfillment of duty of a male, as head of household is portrayed to win over his desire toward love relationship with Rachel. Although Rachel is a visual projection of missing ideal characteristic of a woman in Iran his moral obligation to return home and secure a fine living is prioritized as can be seen by how the novel ends. In film, however, such socially constructed definition of male duty is all together avoided by omitting the existence of his wife in the first place. This liberates Deckard to autonomously act upon his own principle of life, to be concerned with safety of Rachel whom he is most fond of. Thus, he becomes a counter-cultural figure that goes beyond the established gender binary.

Another turning point to look at is the relationship between gender and commodification of human body of robots. [6]Popular fallacy of humanism was that it only assigned its central characteristic of rationalism to male gender leaving female gender behind in religious domain.

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[5] Gavey, Nicola. "Feminist Poststructuralism and Discourse Analysis: Contributions to Feminist Psychology." Psychology of Women Quarterly, vol. 13, no. 4, 1989, pp. 459–475., doi:10.1111/j.1471-6402.1989.tb01014.x.
[6] Ehrenfeld, David W. The Arrogance of Humanism. Oxford University Press, 1981.

To simply put, the emotional and less rational part of human was thought to be the defining characteristic of women, which justified their inferiority. This idea has as mentioned, been overturned in film rendition when male protagonist was written to carry subtle emotional sensibility, straying away from progress-driving figure of men in humanism. As for the case of opposite gender, one thing to note is that all female characters that have survived to enter the movie edition were robots. Thus, each of their characteristic serves as a barometer to determine whether those preconceived notion bears hope to be rectified in the future or not, since androids are in director's world a future embodiment of human. In movie, Pris one android character originally written to have same exterior as Rachel, is marked by a completely different appearance. Designating one uniqueness per character diversifies commodification and sends message that upcoming world will not be gender-reductive where every woman is considered as similar to one another. Not all female is emotionally driven individuals that bears same appearance. In future capitalistic science-oriented world, commodification could work in direction to accept non-stereotyped differences instead towards unification of individuality.

So far, the detailed examinations can be summarized into transcendence of preconceived humanist notion on gender-based identity and characteristics. Compared to the initial storyline, this novel has been rewritten in the perspective of post-humanist decentralization of gender. It attempts to blur the clear-cut definition of gender postulating it as fluid and equivocal subject. Although Do Androids Dream of Electric Sheep? criticizes human-oriented culture of humanism, Blade Runner sheds new light on gender relationship and status. However, it is an undeniable fact that like mentioned previously, both plots are primarily male driven which hints its lingering humanist influence. Humanism being the white man's burden with sole emphasis put on male dominated culture, the coexistence of two conflicting elements reflects chaos of that era. Both humanist and decentralized feminist ideal were fighting its place in society and the fact that feminist ideal has been more greatly emphasized in the movie, indicates growing influence of feminist movement occurred during 14 years of generational gap.

In fact, this was the era when second wave of feminist movement hit in the aftermath of World War2. [7]Just 5 years prior to publication of the novel, Betty Friedan's 'The Feminine Mystique (1963)' that spoke the problem of socially conditioned domesticity of women sparked various

[7] Davis, Flora. Moving the Mountain: the Womens Movement in America since 1960. University of Illinois Press, 1999.

organized activism on behalf of women. Establishment of institutionalized support such as NOW (National Organization for Women) was followed by chaotic less-structured radical groups that led women's liberation movement. The 1968 protest on image of womanhood conveyed by the Miss America Pageant, 1969 declaration of Bitch Manifesto by radical liberation group Redstockings all contributed to stirring up the debate on socially constructed femininity. This accompanied by success on liberalization of Divorce Laws, creation of women's study program in colleges and universities and controversial ruling regarding abortion in 1973 Roe v. Wade forged growing recognition on feminism.

2.2 Racialized Others

Race is among three themes the one that has not been directly dealt with in both versions of the story. To one's dismay, racial diversity was a field never explored that audience could be trapped into thinking that western-centered characteristic of humanism was failed to be overcome. However, it would be hasty to conclude that the story only succeeded in accounting for sexualized and naturalized others. Although Caucasian was the only race all characters of the plot were part of, figuratively speaking, robots can symbolize racial differences. In this context, exterminating androids, the other race, from earth can be read similar to ethnic cleansing practiced during fascist German regime. Segregating androids from earth and banning their entrance is analogous to how Jews were banned to stay in Nazi's territory during the Holocaust. Since the narrative leads reader to question justifiability of killing androids in the name of being non-human, it indirectly leads to question justifiability of killing Jews in the name of being non-Germanic. Concerning that posthumanism began to thrive being against byproduct of World War Two which includes Fascism, this analogy bears relevance.

Taking this analogy, modification made in movie to impose empathizing ability to androids could be interpreted as social ques that urges harmonious coexistence. The aforementioned plot of Blade Runner on Roy saving Deckard's life in their battle when Deckard dangles from the roof of Sebastian's apartment ends with a following voice over. "I don't know why he saved my life. Maybe in those last moments he loved life more than he ever had before. Not just his life…anybody's life…my life." This narration of Deckard phrases Roy's action as benevolent attitude stripped of antagonistic tension found between androids and human. If that tension is

understood as racism, the scene can be read as projecting hope of peaceful coexistence transcending racial barrier at the peak of racial conflict in history. This would be a speculation never to be made from heartless character of Dick's novel; he might have just simply walked away. [8]However, as the American society experienced numerous racial protests in civil rights movement throughout 1960s, racial equality came as another important subject to be dealt with in posthumanism. Recreating androids possessing a characteristic that once served as strict standard to set them apart from human blurred the boundary between two. Afterall, if there is no apparent discriminating difference, the narrow definition of human becomes groundless. Embracing androids inside the boundary of human and promoting their coexistence resonates with post humanistic turn to expand understandings on what counts as human.

On top of this, there is one minor difference to note on film's change to more racially acceptive perspective. Chinese look and feel of the environment in city of Los Angeles shown at the movie was a movie-only edition. Incorporation of non-western multicultural element unfound in the original plotline implies progress of posthumanism in a less racially exclusive term.

2.3 Naturalized Others

In contrast to racialized otherness, naturalized otherness would be the most straightforward connection the story has with post humanist values. The fear of the unprecedented level of scientific advancement is often the central theme of Sci-Fi genre but this novel particularly stands out in that it invites moral engagement. As the story progress, the message becomes clearer that after all, robots might not be so different from human and their 'retirement' could be equal to murderer. One major plot difference regarding life of androids is that in book, their antagonistic relationship with humans comes from desire to obtain freedom whereas in the movie, it is the desire to extend their limited 4-year lifespan. This lifespan predetermined at their birth put their mind at an unease to live in constant fear of imminent death. Thus, there is a shift of focus from pursuit of liberty to heavier life or death matter. This new shift of emphasis is more in line with how we should approach values of life in non-organic living organisms.

Moreover, the android characters of film version are overall more sinister and manipulative.

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[8] Hampton, Henry, et al. Voices of Freedom: an Oral History of the Civil Rights Movement. Bantam Books, 1990.

Unlike in Dick's novel where they would make the most effort to remain undiscoverable and blend in, robots in the Blade Runner are in active search of remedy to ameliorate their living conditions. They would approach J.F Sebastian, now a genetic engineer for androids at Tyrell corporation, with an intention to get in touch with their creator in order to find a solution to stop their impending death from approaching. When Roy is told that there won't be other alternatives, he brutally murders Tyrell. They are also more calculative in the sense that they try to become part of the organization or public figure to make it impossible to kill or retire them. In the end, these changes reinforce autonomy and agency of robots since it is giving sovereignty over their action. No longer do they passively responds to threats of human in defensive manner, but they are in active charge their destination. This empowerment equalizes their status to human with a matching agency level to think rationally and critically.

The electronic animal, as previously discussed is a unique point of discussion because it falls into category of double naturalization. Because the characteristic of naturalized otherness is twice as concentrated, its change gives vivid picture on how idea of decentralization was processed in 14 years. In book, this is a subject frowned upon, a shame to keep it concealed. Rosen corporation fakes its electronic eagle as real and the society deem possession of real animal as status symbol. However, in film such is not taken as a big deal that Tyrell carelessly states their eagle is fake as whether it is or not does not bear much importance. This decentralizes power organic animal had in the novel. Less strong preference on real animal deconstructs hierarchy of non-electronic and electronic others.

Among simplification process the movie went through, the fake android's world of bounty hunters that Luba Luft, Zora in the movie, drew Deckard into was erased. This scene of the novel that plays trick to Deckard, is an embodiment of fear when the world has been antagonistically taken over by naturalized others. Perhaps the tendency to put non-human, yet human-based replicants in naturalized position comes from this imaginary source that traps one to think that if robots were given autonomy, it would inevitably work against existing humanity. However, as the film hints on possibility of peaceful coexistence, this apprehensive scenario might have been erased as the two world views conflict. Thus, by instead injecting a message on harmony rather than conflict it attempts to withdraw hatred that supports logic of discrimination that have put naturalized others outside of the humanist categorical divide.

3. Conclusion

Starting from a question on how loyal the movie was to the book, this research attempted to account for disparity as a reflection of social changes during the period at the height of counter-culture dynamics. 1960s and 1970s experienced an overturn of cultural values along with burgeoning ideas of posthumanism stretching from field of civil rights movement to feminism. Two national pressure group NAACP: National Association for the Advancement of Colored People and NOW: National Organization for Women epitomizes racial and gender discourse prevalent at the era and the influence these had on society. Advancement of technology on top of this, further complicated the question to examine how we will deal with newly formed identity of individuals whose agency depends on science. Although the two renditions shared the same backbone of the story, the variations seemed to reflect aspects of ongoing dynamics.

Overall the changes can be summarized as progress towards transcendence on narrow definition of human, deconstructing white-male dominated field of humanism. The plot-driving protagonist of both versions, Rick Deckard, belonged to privileged class in humanist world view so the stories were, essentially a journey of man in power coming to understand the life of marginalized others. While Deckard in both comes to sympathize with these 'others' the context is slightly different. In the novel, the empathy stemmed from androids' close resemblance to human; they felt too human to have their life neglected. On the contrary, Rick in Blade Runner empathizes with replicants as he doubts 'his' identity as human, thinking that he too might be replicants after all. Here the mode of empathy reflects the way humanist hierarchy was deconstructed. The former was done in top down measure, valuing life of androids, lower ranked entity, because they bear similarity with human, a higher ranked entity. Reversely, the latter counted on bottom-up measure because it decentralized established entity of white man setting replicants as the standard to follow the characteristic of.

This central difference recapitulates how the idea has shifted. Even if both book and the movie centered around theme of decentralizing power structure in three different terms, their fundamental premise was different. Book, which resembles earlier development of post humanist ideas had not yet completely shed-off humanist influence by putting its narrow definition at the center of evaluation. Movie, which resembles later progress, showed a march towards more progressive ideal with the central focus on rights of others, in their stance instead that of privileged class individuals.

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